

Printmaking

Prints allow artists to reproduce numerous copies of one image. They are made using three main methods, each with several variations. These are relief printing, where the background is cut away or incised and a raised image takes the ink; intaglio, from the Italian *intagliare* ('to engrave'); and planographic, or printing from flat surfaces, as for example, in lithography, which works on the basis that water does not mix with oil.

Woodcut printing was invented in China in the fifth century but did not become popular in Europe until the 15th, when it was used particularly masterfully by Dürer. In the 17th and 18th centuries Rembrandt and Goya produced powerful etchings, and Velázquez and Turner were among several artists whose work became well known abroad through prints of their paintings. After Japanese *Ukiyo-e* prints gained popularity in the later 19th century, some of the most renowned artists such as Toulouse-Lautrec, Gauguin, Matisse and Andy Warhol used various printing techniques, including lithography and screen-printing.



Rembrandt, *Self Portrait with Cap Pulled Forward*, c.1631